

Employing Household Help in Basel-Stadt

A complete guide for private employers

Companion file: Payslip_2026.xlsx

2026 rates | legal-source review: July 2026

Purpose of this document

This guide helps private individuals in Basel-Stadt employ a household cleaner legally, fairly, and with as little administrative effort as possible. Employing someone in your home makes you an employer under Swiss law; but for a few hours a week, the process is genuinely simple once it is set up. This document, together with the companion spreadsheet, gives you everything you need: how to register, how to pay correctly, and what to do if something out of the ordinary comes up.

It is organised in two parts. **Part A: The Normal Case** covers setting up and running a smooth, ongoing arrangement. **Part B: Exceptions** is a reference for when things are not routine: illness, accidents, breakages, disputes, or ending the employment. You only need Part B when something specific happens.

Note: This guide is compiled from publicly available information (primarily the Ausgleichskasse Basel-Stadt, SECO, and the Swiss Code of Obligations) and reflects rates and procedures as of 2026, with a legal-source review completed in July 2026. It is provided for general information only and is not legal, tax, or financial advice. Rules change and individual situations differ; for a specific question, check the official sources linked throughout or consult the AWA or a qualified adviser.

Contents

PART A: The Normal Case

How it all works (background)
Setting up: register with the Ausgleichskasse
Setting up: sign an employment contract
Setting up: agree the scope and your working-style preferences
Setting up: prepare the payslip spreadsheet
Running it: calculate and pay monthly wages
Running it: issue a payslip
Running it: holiday and public-holiday pay
Running it: bonuses and expense reimbursements
Running it: the year-end wage report
Running it: update contribution rates each January

PART B: Exceptions & Things Going Wrong

If your employee is ill (sick pay)
If your employee has an accident at work
If your employee breaks something
If work drifts from what you agreed (scope problems)
If you need to raise a problem
If there is a dispute
If you suspect theft
If you want to end the employment
Deregister with the Ausgleichskasse

REFERENCE: Rates, tables, contacts

2026 contribution rates
Minimum wages (NAV Hauswirtschaft)
Notice periods
Sick-pay rules (Basel household NAV)
Official links and contacts
What to keep on file

PART A

The Normal Case

Setting up and running a smooth, ongoing arrangement

BACKGROUND

How it all works

German: vereinfachtes Abrechnungsverfahren (VAV): simplified settlement procedure

Switzerland created the simplified procedure specifically so that private households can employ domestic help without the heavy payroll administration a business faces. It exists under the Federal Act against Illegal Employment (BGSA), which aims to bring casual domestic work into the formal system so that workers receive proper social insurance, accident cover, and pension contributions.

You register once with the cantonal compensation office (the Ausgleichskasse Basel-Stadt). From then on, all social insurance contributions: old-age pension (AHV), disability (IV), income replacement (EO), unemployment (ALV), family allowances (FAK), accident insurance, and withholding tax, are reported and settled once per year through that single office. There is no monthly filing and no payroll software required.

The simplified procedure is available only if each employee earns no more than CHF 22,680 gross per year and the employer's total annual payroll does not exceed CHF 60,480. All contributory wages must be included in the procedure. A small household employment arrangement will usually remain below these limits.

Note: Under the simplified procedure, deduct 6.4% employee AHV/IV/EO and ALV contributions and the flat 5% tax from each wage payment. If the employee works at least 8 hours a week for this employer, also deduct the applicable NBU premium. The employer reports the annual gross wage and settles the accumulated contributions and tax with the Ausgleichskasse once per year. The employee receives a tax certificate from the Ausgleichskasse; the employer does not issue a separate Lohnausweis for wages settled through this procedure.

SETUP: DO ONCE

Register with the Ausgleichskasse Basel-Stadt

German: Ausgleichskasse: compensation fund / social insurance office

Registration is done through an online form on the AKBS website; there is nothing to print or post. It takes about 15 minutes once you have the details below to hand.

First, gather these (the form asks for each):

- Your name, date of birth, and home address
- Your employee's name, date of birth, and AHV number (756.XXXX.XXXX.XX)
- Your employee's home address (the simplified procedure handles their tax, so this is required)
- Whether your employee also works abroad (yes/no)
- The date wages start and an estimated annual gross total

Then complete the form:

1 Open the Haushaltshilfen page

Go to ak-bs.ch/ubersicht/beitrage-an-die-ahv-iv-eo/haushaltshilfen/ and scroll to the registration section.

2 Choose the simplified procedure

Select "Abrechnung mit Steuerabzug, vereinfachtes Verfahren" (not "Standard-Abrechnung"; see the note below).

3 Fill in employer, employee, and wage fields

Enter all the details you gathered. For "weitere Erwerbstätigkeit im Ausland" answer Yes only if your employee also works outside Switzerland.

4 Set the accident-insurance option (VAVplus): two answers

At "Haben Sie eine Unfallversicherung abgeschlossen?" answer **Nein**. Then at "Möchten Sie die Unfallversicherungsprämie direkt mit der Ausgleichskasse abrechnen?" answer **Ja**. This bundles accident cover through the AKBS (via SOLIDA) so you need no separate insurer. See Part B: accidents.

5 Choose electronic correspondence (optional)

You can opt to receive future correspondence via the online portal "connect" rather than by post.

6 Submit

The AKBS confirms your registration by post and sends your member number (Mitgliedernummer) and, if chosen, the details needed to use the connect portal.

Note: Register with the Ausgleichskasse within 30 days after the employment begins. Questions: 061 685 22 22.

Who can use the simplified procedure

- Gross wage per employee does not exceed CHF 22,680 in 2026
- Total annual payroll does not exceed CHF 60,480 in 2026
- All contributory wages are settled through the simplified procedure
- No cross-border worker resident in France; ask AKBS about any other cross-border situation
- The employee is not the employer's spouse or child

Note: There is also a Standard-Abrechnung option. The companion spreadsheet and this guide are designed for the simplified procedure with the flat 5% tax deduction. Standard settlement uses different tax and reporting rules, including an annual Lohnausweis, so do not use this spreadsheet unchanged for the standard procedure.

SETUP: DO ONCE

Sign an employment contract

German: Arbeitsvertrag: employment contract

Use a written contract. The official Basel-Stadt AWA hourly contract is the best starting point because it is designed for household staff in this canton and refers directly to the cantonal NAV.

Download the current official template

Go to bs.ch/wsu/awa/arbeitsbeziehungen/arbeitsverhaeltnisse/normalarbeitsvertraege-nav and download **NAV Vertragsmuster Hauspersonal Stundenlohn**. The same page also provides the current cantonal NAV, the employee information sheet, a sample payslip and working-time forms.

For the regular paid-leave model used in this guide

- State the agreed weekly hours and normal workday or workdays
- State the gross hourly wage. The companion workbook is preconfigured to **CHF 28.50 gross per paid hour**
- State four weeks of holiday unless a five-week entitlement applies because of age
- Do not agree to a running monthly payout of holiday compensation for this regular weekly arrangement
- Add a written clarification such as: *Ferien werden effektiv bezogen. Der Ferienlohn wird beim Ferienbezug auf Basis des vereinbarten Bruttostundenlohns ausgerichtet. Keine laufende Auszahlung der Ferienentschädigung.*
- List the agreed tasks or attach a short task list

The contract template shows the mathematical holiday-wage percentage because the holiday portion must remain identifiable. For this regular arrangement, the entitlement is delivered through paid holiday hours when leave is taken, rather than by adding 8.33% to every monthly payment.

The contract should also state:

- Names and addresses of both parties
- Start date; fixed-term or open-ended
- Probation period, if used
- Employee function and scope of work
- Notice periods
- Any agreed procedure for reporting sickness and submitting a medical certificate

Tip: At the start of employment, give the employee the current Basel-Stadt household NAV and the federal NAV Hauswirtschaft, or provide the official links. Sign two contract copies and keep one copy each.

SETUP: DO ONCE

Agree the scope and your working-style preferences

Most friction in household employment is not about money; it is about unspoken expectations. The single most useful thing you can do is be explicit, at the start, about both what you want done and how much latitude the cleaner has in doing it.

1. Define the tasks

Write a simple list of what is included (e.g. kitchen, bathrooms, floors, dusting) and, just as importantly, what is not: rooms to leave alone, items not to touch, anything you would rather handle yourself. A short checklist avoids most misunderstandings and gives the cleaner confidence they are doing the right things.

2. Be clear about your working style: latitude vs. precision

People differ enormously here, and neither preference is wrong. What matters is that your cleaner knows which kind of household yours is, because they cannot guess.

If you are happy with latitude (you do not mind initiative and reorganisation):

- Say so explicitly: e.g. "If you think something would work better in a different place, go ahead. I trust your judgement."
- This frees the cleaner to use their experience and usually produces a better result.

If you prefer precision (you want things left exactly where they were):

- Say so just as explicitly: e.g. "Please put everything back exactly where you found it, and don't reorganise cupboards or shelves, even if it looks like it could be improved."
- Point out specific sensitive areas (a desk, a particular shelf, a child's room).

***Tip:** Framing this as a preference, not a rule, keeps the tone respectful: "I'm a bit particular about where things go" lands better than a list of prohibitions. A cleaner who reorganises your cupboard is almost always trying to help; if that is not what you want, the fix is to say so kindly up front, not to treat it as a problem later. See Part B: scope problems if it comes up after the fact.*

3. Put it somewhere both of you can refer to

Attach the task list to the contract, or keep it as a shared note. It is not a legal document; it is a shared understanding you can both point back to.

SETUP: DO ONCE

Prepare the payslip spreadsheet

Open Payslip_2026.xlsx and complete the blue cells on the Rates sheet. The workbook is preconfigured for the selected 2026 AKBS and VAvplus route.

Enter or confirm:

- Employer name and address
- Employee name, AHV number and permit type
- Gross hourly wage: CHF 28.50 unless a different amount is agreed
- Employment start date and, if known, end date
- Regular weekly hours with this employer
- Holiday entitlement in weeks

The workbook determines whether the NBU deduction applies from the regular weekly hours. It also pro-rates the 2026 holiday entitlement using the contract dates. The 2026 AKBS and VAvplus rates are prefilled on the Rates sheet.

Note: Blue cells are input cells. Calculated cells should not be overwritten. Save one workbook per calendar year and update the official rates each January.

RUNNING IT: EACH MONTH

Calculate and pay monthly wages

1 Record the month

Keep the dates and hours for each visit, plus any paid holiday, paid public-holiday or paid sick-leave hours.

2 Open the correct month tab

Each month is already formatted as a payslip.

3 Enter paid hours

B8: hours worked; B9: paid holiday hours; B10: paid public-holiday hours; B11: paid sick-leave hours.

4 Enter holiday work correctly

If work was actually performed on a statutory holiday, include the hours in B8 and repeat them in B12 so the additional 50% premium is calculated. Do not also enter the same hours as paid public-holiday leave.

5 Enter any extras

B13: cash bonus or other taxable wage; B14: documented expense reimbursement; B15: optional hourly-wage override.

6 Pay the total

Transfer the amount shown at TOTAL PAYMENT TO EMPLOYEE. The sheet deducts AHV/IV/EO, ALV, the 5% tax and, where applicable, NBU.

The monthly TOTAL EMPLOYER COST includes gross wages, employer contributions and documented expense reimbursements. It is an administrative total, not an advertised hourly-price table.

RUNNING IT: EACH MONTH

Issue a payslip

The Basel household NAV requires a written payslip with the wage payment. It must show all allowances, supplements and deductions, and it must show the holiday balance. The companion workbook provides those items.

1 Complete the month sheet

Check every input and the employee details pulled from the Rates sheet.

2 Enter the payslip date

Use the final row of the month sheet.

3 Save or print it

Export the month tab as PDF or print it.

4 Give it to the employee

Emailing the PDF is sufficient. Signatures are optional evidence, not a monthly legal requirement.

Note: Keep the workbook, payslips, annual AKBS declarations and AKBS invoices together. This guide recommends retaining payroll and AKBS records for 10 years as a conservative practical measure; it is not claiming that one identical statutory period applies to every document.

RUNNING IT

Paid holiday and public holidays

German: *Ferienlohn*: holiday wage | *gesetzliche Feiertage*: statutory public holidays

Most adult employees receive four weeks of paid holiday per service year. Employees under 20 and employees over 50 receive five weeks under the Basel household NAV. Part-year and part-time entitlements are proportional.

Holiday for this regular weekly arrangement

- Holiday is taken as actual time off
- The normal scheduled hours are paid at the agreed gross hourly wage when the holiday is taken
- Enter those hours as Paid holiday hours on the relevant monthly sheet
- The Rates sheet and each payslip show the remaining holiday balance
- At least two weeks of the annual holiday should be consecutive

The NAV expresses four weeks of holiday as 8.33% of the usual wage. In this workbook that percentage is not automatically added to each monthly payment: paid holiday hours deliver the entitlement when leave is taken.

Basel-Stadt public holidays

- A statutory holiday is paid only when it falls on a day the employee would normally have worked
- Enter the normal scheduled hours as Paid public-holiday hours when no work is performed
- If the employee works on the holiday, include the hours as worked and apply the additional 50% premium through the separate input
- Do not add a blanket public-holiday percentage every month

Note: The exact number of paid public holidays therefore varies with the agreed weekday and the calendar. The workbook records the actual dates rather than using a weekday-cost table.

RUNNING IT: OCCASIONALLY

Bonuses and expense reimbursements

Cash bonus or other extra wage

A cash bonus is normally AHV-liable wage. Enter the gross amount in the dedicated monthly bonus field. It will be included in gross wages, deductions and the annual AKBS total.

Expense reimbursement

A genuine documented business expense is not wage. Enter the exact reimbursed amount in the expense field and keep the receipt or written record. It is added to the payment to the employee but excluded from AHV-liable gross wages.

RUNNING IT: ONCE A YEAR

The year-end wage report

German: Lohnmeldung: annual wage declaration

By 30 January, report the previous year's wages to AKBS. The Rates sheet provides the annual gross-wage total and the supporting payroll totals.

1 Check the Rates sheet

Confirm the yearly gross wage, employee deductions, employer costs and holiday balance.

2 Complete the AKBS wage declaration

Use the form or connect portal instructions sent by AKBS.

3 Submit by 30 January

AKBS invoices the social-insurance contributions, family-allowance contribution, administration charge, VAvplus premium and withheld tax.

4 Pay the invoice on time

Keep the declaration, invoice and payment evidence with the yearly workbook.

RUNNING IT: ONCE A YEAR

Update contribution rates each January

1 Check the official AKBS pages

Use ak-bs.ch/ubersicht/beitrage-an-die-ahv-iv-eo/haushaltshilfen/ and the current AKBS calculation example.

2 Update the Rates sheet

The editable 2026 rates are grouped together on the Rates sheet. Review every rate, threshold and accident premium.

3 Create the new-year file

Save a fresh copy, for example Payslip_2027.xlsx, before entering new-year payroll.

PART B

Exceptions & Things Going Wrong

Reference for when the arrangement is not routine

Each topic below is self-contained: it explains the situation, tells you what to do, and points to any rates or tables you need. You only need a topic when it applies.

EXCEPTION

If your employee is ill (sick pay)

German: Lohnfortzahlung: continued payment of wages

The Basel household NAV provides continued wage payment from the beginning of the contract when the employee is unable to work through no fault of their own, subject to any applicable insurance benefits.

NAV duration: one month in service year 1; two months in years 2-3; three months in years 4-10; four months in years 11-15; five months in years 16-20; and six months from year 21.

What to do:

- 1 Ask the employee to notify you immediately**
Record the first day and the scheduled hours affected.
- 2 Request the medical certificate when required**
If the absence lasts more than three working days, the NAV requires the employee to provide a certificate promptly and without being asked.
- 3 Pay covered scheduled hours**
Enter them as Paid sick-leave hours on the monthly sheet. Sick pay remains AHV-liable wage.
- 4 Check insurance interaction**
If an accident insurer or sickness daily-allowance insurer pays benefits, do not duplicate the same wage replacement. Ask AKBS or AWA if the calculation is unclear.

Note: Wage-continuation periods and the protected periods for employer notice are different rules. See ending the employment before giving notice during an absence.

EXCEPTION

If your employee has an accident

Under VAvplus, SOLIDA provides the accident insurance and AKBS collects the premium with the annual settlement. The 2026 occupational-accident rate is 0.505%, paid by the employer. If the employee works at least 8 hours a week for this employer, NBU cover also applies at 1.432%, normally deducted from the employee's wage.

What to do:

- 1 Arrange medical help if needed**
Deal with urgent care first.
- 2 Record the incident**
Note the date, time, place, work being performed and any witnesses.
- 3 Report it promptly**
Follow the AKBS / SOLIDA accident-reporting instructions and keep copies.
- 4 Coordinate wage replacement**
Insurance benefits and NAV wage continuation can interact. Use Paid sick-leave hours only for the wage the employer actually owes.

***Note:** The 8-hour NBU test is per employer. Below that threshold, the employer still pays occupational accident cover, but VAvplus does not charge the employee NBU premium for that employment.*

EXCEPTION

If your employee breaks something

German: Haftung: liability

The employee is responsible for damage caused intentionally or negligently. The required standard of care depends on the actual job, its risks, the employee's training and the abilities known to the employer. This means liability cannot be decided from the value of the item alone.

What to do:

- 1 Document the facts**
Record what happened and photograph the damage where useful.
- 2 Discuss it before deciding liability**
Ordinary accidents, negligence and intentional damage are not treated identically.
- 3 Do not make an automatic wage deduction**
Set-off against wages is legally restricted. For a significant dispute, contact AWA or obtain legal advice before deducting anything.
- 4 Notify the relevant insurer**
Check household or personal-liability cover where appropriate, without assuming that every loss is covered.

EXCEPTION

If work drifts from what you agreed (scope problems)

If your cleaner is doing things you did not ask for, reorganising, cleaning areas you wanted left alone, or moving your belongings, this is almost always a communication gap, not misconduct. They are typically trying to help.

What to do:

1 Revisit the scope, kindly

Go back to the task list and working-style conversation from Part A: scope. Restate your preference as a preference, not a complaint.

2 Be specific about sensitive areas

"Please leave the desk and the bookshelf exactly as they are" is clearer than "don't move things".

3 Update the shared task list

So there is a single reference you can both point to.

Tip: If you realise you never actually stated your preference, that is worth acknowledging; it makes the conversation collaborative rather than corrective.

EXCEPTION

If you need to raise a problem

For any concern, whether quality, timekeeping, scope, or conduct, the same calm, documented approach applies and resolves the large majority of issues.

1 Raise it directly and early

A specific, factual, in-person conversation. Avoid letting small things accumulate.

2 Give a chance to put it right

Most issues resolve here. Be clear about what you'd like to change.

3 Document it

A brief written follow-up (message or note) of what was discussed and agreed.

4 If it recurs, consider a written warning

A warning is not a universal prerequisite for ordinary notice, but it creates a clear record and may be important before relying on repeated conduct for an immediate dismissal.

Note: Keep records factual and dated. If it ever reaches a dispute, your contemporaneous notes are what matter; see disputes.

EXCEPTION

If there is a dispute

If a disagreement cannot be resolved directly, free cantonal help is available before anything reaches a court.

- Employment-law questions (contract, notice, sick pay): the Amt für Wirtschaft und Arbeit (AWA) employment-law advice service: 061 267 88 09. Current opening times and appointment information are published at bs.ch/wsu/awa/arbeitsbeziehungen/arbeitsverhaeltnisse/rechtsberatung.
- Unresolved disputes: the cantonal conciliation board (Schlichtungsbehörde) for employment matters provides free conciliation; it is the required first step before the labour court.

***Tip:** Bring your contract, payslips, and your dated notes. Contemporaneous records are decisive in employment disputes.*

EXCEPTION: SENSITIVE

If you suspect theft

Proceed carefully. A missing item is not proof, and an unsupported accusation can create serious employment and reputational consequences.

What to do:

- 1 Check the facts first**
Search carefully and write down exactly what is missing, when it was last seen and who had access.
- 2 Secure valuables without confrontation**
Reduce further risk while keeping the discussion factual.
- 3 Consider a police report only where justified**
Theft is a criminal allegation; do not use it merely as leverage in an employment disagreement.
- 4 Contact AWA before immediate dismissal**
Immediate dismissal is exceptional and must be handled promptly and correctly. Use the AWA employment-contract legal advice service before acting.

***Note:** Do not rely on a fixed two- or three-day rule from a general guide. The correct response depends on the evidence, any necessary investigation and the seriousness of the situation. AWA employment law advice: bs.ch/wsu/awa/arbeitsbeziehungen/arbeitsverhaeltnisse/rechtsberatung; telephone 061 267 88 09.*

EXCEPTION

If you want to end the employment

German: Kündigung: notice / termination

Ordinary notice must be in writing. A reason is not automatically required in the notice letter, but the other party may request the reason.

Notice periods under the Basel household NAV: 7 days during probation; after probation, 1 month in service year 1, 2 months in years 2-9, and 3 months from year 10. After probation, notice normally takes effect at the end of a month.

What to do:

1 Give written notice

Date it and make sure receipt can be shown.

2 Check protected periods

After probation, illness, accident, pregnancy and certain public-service absences can restrict employer notice or interrupt a running notice period. Contact AWA if one applies.

3 Plan the remaining holiday

Holiday should normally be taken during the notice period. If a residual entitlement genuinely cannot be taken before the end, settle it correctly in the final payroll.

4 Complete the final payslip

Include worked hours, covered paid leave, deductions, reimbursements and the final holiday balance.

5 Provide the work reference

The Basel household NAV requires the employer to provide the work reference no later than the last day, without waiting for a request.

6 Recover keys and household property

Use a brief signed handover note where keys or valuable property were issued.

7 Report the employee exit to AKBS

Then complete the final annual wage declaration in the normal way.

EXCEPTION

Deregister with the Ausgleichskasse

When a cleaner leaves, you report their exit so their record is closed and the final year is settled correctly. Closing your own employer account is a separate, optional step.

Reporting the employee's exit

1 Use the online exit form

The exit (Austritt) form for an already-registered employer is at ak-bs.ch under Firmen → Mitarbeitende → Austritte von Mitarbeitenden. Enter the employee and the end date.

2 Report final wages

File the Lohnmeldung for wages paid up to the end date. Timing: report the exit promptly, but at the latest with your normal year-end wage declaration.

3 Keep your records

Keep the contract, payslips, annual declaration, AKBS invoices and supporting records together. This guide recommends 10 years for payroll and AKBS records.

Do you have to close your employer account?

No. You can stay registered as an employer even with no current employee. Under the simplified procedure there are no provisional quarterly bills (Akontobeiträge), so an idle registration does not generate charges. The AKBS simply sends the year-end wage-declaration request; you report zero wages for any year you employed nobody.

***Tip:** Staying registered can save time if you expect to employ household help again. A zero-wage declaration may still be required for a year with no employee. Use the AKBS electronic entry/exit form to report each new employee and departure; do not rely only on the year-end wage declaration.*

If you want to close the account entirely

1 Submit the closure form

Tell the AKBS you no longer employ anyone (the "keine Angestellten mehr" / employer-deregistration form). They close your employer record.

2 Settle the final year

They issue a final invoice based on your last wage declaration. Once paid, nothing further is expected.

3 If you used VAvplus, your accident cover ends with it

Closing the account ends the accident insurance bundled through the AKBS. This only matters if you employ someone again, in which case you re-arrange cover at that point.

REFERENCE

Rates, tables, contacts

2026 rates; source review completed July 2026

2026 payroll rates for the selected AKBS route

Item	Rate	Paid by	Workbook treatment
AHV/IV/EO	10.6% total	50/50	5.3% employee + 5.3% employer
ALV	2.2% total	50/50	1.1% employee + 1.1% employer
Simplified-procedure tax	5%	Employee	Deduct from each wage payment
FAK	1.65%	Employer	AKBS 2026 rate
AKBS administration	5% of AHV/IV/EO contribution	Employer	About 0.53% of gross
VAvplus BU	0.505%	Employer	Occupational accident insurance
VAvplus NBU	1.432%	Employee	Only from 8 hours/week with that employer

Note: Holiday and public-holiday pay are not automatic monthly percentage additions in this workbook. The employee is paid the agreed gross hourly wage for the applicable paid-leave hours.

Minimum wages: federal NAV Hauswirtschaft 2026

The federal minimum-wage table applies to employment relationships of at least 5 hours per week. The amounts are gross base hourly wages, before any separate holiday or paid-public-holiday supplement used in a different payroll model.

Qualification	Minimum hourly wage	Official category
Unskilled	CHF 20.35	Ungelernt
Unskilled, at least 4 years experience	CHF 22.30	Ungelernt mit mindestens 4 Jahren Berufserfahrung
Two-year training / EBA	CHF 22.30	Gelernt mit EBA
Three-year training / EFZ	CHF 24.55	Gelernt mit EFZ

Paid holiday and public-holiday reference

Situation	Treatment
Most adult employees	4 weeks paid holiday per service year
Under 20 or over 50	5 weeks under the Basel household NAV
Regular weekly arrangement	Holiday taken as leave; normal scheduled hours are paid
Basel statutory holiday on normal workday	Normal scheduled hours paid if no work is performed
Work actually performed on Sunday/statutory holiday	Gross wage plus at least 50% premium, unless a lawful written fixed-holiday-work arrangement applies

Notice periods

Service stage	Notice	Effective date
Probation	7 days	Any day
Service year 1	1 month	End of a month
Service years 2-9	2 months	End of a month
From service year 10	3 months	End of a month

Sick-pay duration: Basel household NAV

Service years	Continued wage
Year 1	1 month
Years 2-3	2 months
Years 4-10	3 months
Years 11-15	4 months
Years 16-20	5 months
From year 21	6 months

Note: The obligation begins with the contract. If an absence lasts more than three working days, the NAV requires the employee to provide a medical certificate promptly and without being asked.

Official links and contacts

Resource	Official link / contact
AKBS household employment	ak-bs.ch/ubersicht/beitrage-an-die-ahv-iv-eo/haushaltshilfen/
AKBS simplified procedure	ak-bs.ch/ubersicht/beitrage-an-die-ahv-iv-eo/vereinfachtes-verfahren/
AKBS telephone	061 685 22 22
Basel AWA household NAV and templates	bs.ch/wsu/awa/arbeitsbeziehungen/arbeitsverhaeltnisse/normalarbeitsvertraege-nav
Current Basel household NAV	gesetzessammlung.bs.ch/app/de/texts_of_law/215.700
AWA employment-law advice	bs.ch/wsu/awa/arbeitsbeziehungen/arbeitsverhaeltnisse/rechtsberatung 061 267 88 09
SECO private-employer guidance and 2026 model contracts	seco.admin.ch/de/anleitung-anmeldung-arbeitsverhaeltnis-und-lohnabrechnung
AHV/IV leaflet 2.06: domestic work	ahv-iv.ch/p/2.06.d
AHV/IV leaflet 2.07: simplified procedure	ahv-iv.ch/p/2.07.d

What to keep on file

Document group	Practical treatment
Employment basis	Signed contract, task list, current NAV links/copies and permit evidence
Monthly payroll	Time records, monthly payslips, leave and sickness records
Annual AKBS file	Wage declaration, AKBS invoice, payment evidence and yearly workbook
Accidents or disputes	Reports, correspondence, photographs, medical/insurance records where applicable

Note: As a conservative practical recommendation, retain payroll and AKBS records for 10 years. Keep active contracts and unresolved accident or dispute records for as long as they remain relevant. This is not a claim that every listed document has the same statutory minimum retention period.

This guide describes one deliberately simple Basel-Stadt route for regular weekly household employment. Rates are for 2026 and were reviewed in July 2026. Verify rates again each January. For a specific dispute or unusual case, contact the AWA or another qualified adviser.